

Takumi Matsuzawa

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EDUCATION	University of Chicago, Chicago, IL 2016 - 2023 Ph.D., Physics, Dissertation: <i>Life, death, and propagation of turbulence</i> Committee: William T. M. Irvine (Chair), Sidney R. Nagel, Fausto Cattaneo, Stephanie Palmer M.S., Physics, Project title: <i>Splashing of low-viscosity fluid</i> 2016 - 2017 Mentor: Sidney R. Nagel Kalamazoo College, Kalamazoo, MI 2013 - 2016 B.A., Physics and Chemistry, <i>summa cum laude with distinction</i> Mentor: Jan Tobochnik
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RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS	Nanyang Technological University , School of Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering Nanyang Assistant Professor Starting in 2027 Cornell University , Laboratory of Atomic and Solid State Physics Schmidt Science Postdoctoral Fellow 2024 - present Postdoctoral Associate 2023 - 2024 Mentor: Eric R. Dufresne
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FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS	Science as Art Competition , 1st Prize, University of Chicago 2026 BPS 2026 Travel Award, Biophysical Society 2026 Schmidt Science Fellowship , Schmidt Sciences in partnership with the Rhodes Trust 2024 - 2026 Grainger Foundation Fellowship , University of Chicago 2022 - 2023 Gallery of Fluid Motion Award , APS Division of Fluid Dynamics 2022 Sidney Nagel Prize for Creativity in Research , University of Chicago 2020 Robert G. Sachs Fellowship, University of Chicago 2016 John Wesley Hornbeck Prize for Excellence in Physics, Kalamazoo College 2016 Senior Leadership Recognition Award for Excellence in Teaching, Kalamazoo College 2016 Lee Teng Undergraduate Fellowship in Accelerator Science and Engineering, Fermilab 2015 39th Lower Michigan Mathematics Competition, 2nd Place 2015 AWS Fellowship for Science, Kalamazoo College 2014 - 2016
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RESEARCH INTERESTS	Soft condensed matter physics; fluid mechanics; biophysics; biomolecular condensates; liquid-liquid phase separation; complex fluids; turbulence
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PUBLICATIONS	Key publications are marked with ★. <i>Preprints:</i> Partition Coefficients Reveal Changes in Properties of Low-Contrast Biomolecular Condensates K. Varma, D. Matthias, C. B. Shapiro, S. Bailey-Darland, T. Matsuzawa , C. Lorenz, T. Bate, S. J. Thornton, S. Duraivel, R. W. Style, J. P. Sethna, E. R. Dufresne, <i>bioRxiv</i> 10.64898/2026.02.20.707107 (2026). [Link] ; under revision at <i>Nature Communications</i> .
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Journals:

Phase behavior of solvent-nematogen mixtures
 S. Bailey-Darland, **T. Matsuzawa**, Eric R. Dufresne, *Soft Matter*, **123**, 34: 5745–5755, (2026). [\[Link\]](#)

★Susceptibility and Regulation of Biomolecular Condensates by Solutes

T. Matsuzawa, K. Varma, T. Bate, C. Lorenz, K. Larina, J. Bauermann, D. Matthias, T. Grubić, R. W. Style, M. O. Steinmetz, E. R. Dufresne, *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci.*, **123**, 31, e2604434123, (2026). [\[Link\]](#)

Media coverage (selected):

Phys.org (2026), Cell biochemistry beyond membranes [\[Link\]](#)

Cornell Chronicle (2026), Cell biochemistry beyond membranes [\[Link\]](#)

★Nonlinear diffusion and decay of a blob of turbulence spreading into a quiescent fluid

T. Matsuzawa, M. Zhu, N. Goldenfeld, W. T. M. Irvine, *Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci.*, **123**, 7,

e2526858123, (2026). [\[Link\]](#); selected for [cover image](#).

Media coverage (selected):

Phys.org (2026), A ‘blob’ in a tank is helping scientists tease out the secrets of turbulence [\[Link\]](#)

The University of Chicago (2026): UChicago Science as Art Competition, 1st Prize [\[Link\]](#)

★Self-propulsion, flocking and chiral active phases from particles spinning at intermediate Reynolds numbers

P. Chen, S. Weady, S. Atis, **T. Matsuzawa**, M. Shelley, W. T. M. Irvine, *Nature Physics*, **21**, 146–154 (2025). [\[Link\]](#); selected for [cover image](#).

Media coverage (selected):

Nature Physics, News & Views (2024): “Spinning into new regimes” [\[Link\]](#)

Phys.org (2024): “Tiny rotating particles create vorticity in viscous fluids, yielding fascinating new behaviors” [\[Link\]](#)

★Creation of an isolated turbulent blob fed by vortex rings

T. Matsuzawa, N. P. Mitchell, S. Perrard, W. T. M. Irvine, *Nature Physics*, **19**, 1193–1200 (2023). [\[Link\]](#); selected for [cover image](#).

Research Briefing:

Turbulence can be sustained and controlled using coherent vortex rings,

T. Matsuzawa, W. T. M. Irvine, *Nature Physics*, **19**, 1088–1089 (2023). [\[Link\]](#)

Media coverage (selected):

Nature, Research Highlight (2023): “Smash-ups make a tame blob of turbulence.” [\[Link\]](#)

Quanta Magazine (2020): “An unexpected twist lights up the secrets of turbulence.” [\[Link\]](#)

Turbulence through sustained vortex ring collisions

T. Matsuzawa, N. P. Mitchell, S. Perrard, W. T. M. Irvine, *Physical Review Fluids*, **8**, 11507 (2023). [\[Link\]](#)

Multi-scale modeling of altered synaptic plasticity related to amyloid β effects

T. Matsuzawa, L. Zálányi, T. Kiss, and P. Érdi, *Neural Networks*, **93**, 230–239 (2017). [\[Link\]](#)

Book chapters:

Connecting epilepsy and Alzheimer’s disease: Modeling of normal and pathological rhythmicity and synaptic plasticity related to amyloid β effects

P. Érdi, **T. Matsuzawa**, T. John, T. Kiss, and L. Zálányi. In *Computational Neurology and Psychiatry*, pp. 93–120. Springer, Cham. (2017). [\[Link\]](#)

Workshop papers (peer-reviewed):

Evaluating machine learning models with NERO: non-equivariance revealed on orbits

Z. Zhao, **T. Matsuzawa**, W. T. M. Irvine, M. Maire, G. L. Kindlmann, *NeurIPS Workshop on Interpretable AI* (2024). [\[Link\]](#)

Commentary:

Wetting beyond equilibrium

T. Matsuzawa, *Nature Physics*, (2026). DOI: 10.1038/s41567-026-03252-0; *invited*. [\[Link\]](#)

In preparation:

Liquid FUS protein condensates exhibit a gas-like structure

C. Lorenz, N. Hess, S. Bailey-Darland, **T. Matsuzawa**, T. Bate, G. Wang, K. Varma, D. Matthias, H. Koganti, L. Pollack, B. Schuler, J. Joseph, and E. R. Dufresne.

Small-angle X-ray scattering from phase-separated mixtures

S. Bailey-Darland, C. Lorenz, **T. Matsuzawa**, T. Bate, U. Wiesner, V. Elser, B. Schuler, and E. R. Dufresne.

TALKS

2026 Northeast Regional Disordered Proteins Workshop: Function Without Form, Syracuse, NY
Sep 2026

“Susceptibility and Regulation of Biomolecular Condensates by Solutes“

Stony Brook University, Simons Center for Geometry and Physics, Stony Brook, NY	Sep 2026
“Nonlinear diffusion and decay of a turbulent blob” (<i>invited</i>)	
Kyushu University, Fukuoka, Japan	May 2026
“Susceptibility and Regulation of Biomolecular Condensates by Solutes” (<i>invited; Japanese</i>)	
Nanyang Technological University, The School of Mechanical and Aerospace Engineering, online	
“Propagation and Decay of a Turbulent Blob” (<i>invited</i>)	May 2026
Kalamazoo College Physics Department Seminar, Kalamazoo, MI	Apr 2026
“From smoke rings to turbulence” (<i>invited</i>)	
Biophysical Society Annual Meetings, San Francisco, CA	Feb 2026
“Designing enzymatic regulation of biomolecular condensates”	
- Won BPS Travel Award to attend	
Simons Seminars on Turbulence, Simons Foundation, online	Dec 2025
“Nonlinear diffusion and decay of an expanding turbulent blob” (<i>invited</i>)	
2025 Interdisciplinary Science Summit, Pasadena, CA	Jul 2025
“Liquid machinery in cells: A physicist’s pivot” (<i>invited</i>)	
Syracuse University Soft Matter and Biological Physics Seminar, Syracuse, NY	May 2025
“Expanding into quiescence: how turbulence spreads and decays” (<i>invited</i>)	
APS March Meeting, Minneapolis, MN	Mar 2024
“Decay and nonlinear diffusion of turbulence”	
APS Division of Fluid Dynamics, Washington D.C.	Nov 2023
“Decay and propagation of an isolated turbulent blob”	
APS March Meeting, Las Vegas, NV	Mar 2023
“Life, death, and propagation of an isolated turbulent blob fed by vortex loops”	
APS Division of Fluid Dynamics, Indianapolis, IN	Nov 2022
“Creation of an isolated turbulent blob sustained by vortex ring injection”	
Okinawa Institute of Science and Technology, Okinawa, Japan	Dec 2022
“Creation of an isolated turbulent blob fed by vortex rings” (<i>invited</i>)	
APS March Meeting, Chicago, IL	Mar 2022
“Creation of an isolated turbulent blob sustained by vortex ring injection”	
University of Chicago JFI Friday Seminar, Chicago, IL	Jan 2022
“From vortex reconnections to turbulence” (<i>invited</i>)	
APS March Meeting (virtual)	Mar 2021
“Confined turbulence through multiple vortex ring collision”	
APS Division of Fluid Dynamics (virtual)	Nov 2020
“Realization of confined turbulence through multiple vortex ring collision”	
University of Chicago JFI Friday Seminar, Chicago, IL	May 2019
“How does nature cook and eat up a turbulent puff?”	
APS March Meeting, Boston, MA	Mar 2018
“Realization of confined turbulence through multiple vortex ring collision”	
University of Chicago JFI Friday Seminar, Chicago, IL	Apr 2017
“Confinement of turbulence” (<i>invited</i>)	
Complex Systems Conference, Kalamazoo, MI	Dec 2017
“Multi-scale modeling of altered synaptic plasticity related to amyloid- β effects”	
Research Expo, Fermi National Accelerator Laboratory, Batavia, IL	Aug 2016
“Targeting studies of the second-generation Mu2e experiment” [Link]	
Research Expo, KEK (High Energy Accelerator Research Organization), Japan	Aug 2014
“Laser break-down spectroscopy on alloys”	

POSTER
PRESENTATIONS

Gordon Research Seminar & Conference: Soft Condensed Matter Physics	Aug 2025
“Local probes of high-dimensional phase equilibria for Biomolecular Condensates” [PDF]	
The 12th Liquid Matter Conference, Mainz, Germany	Sep 2024
“Solutes shift phase equilibria of biomolecular condensates” [PDF]	
Simons Foundation Workshop: Turbulence Across Vast Scales, New York, NY	Dec 2019
“Realization of confined turbulence through multiple vortex ring collision” [PDF]	
Annual Meeting of Society for Neuroscience, Chicago, IL	Mar 2016
“Modeling altered synaptic plasticity due to amyloid- β ”	
Annual Users Meeting, Fermi National Accelerator Laboratory, Batavia, IL	Jun 2015

	“Targeting studies of the second-generation Mu2e experiment” Research Symposium, KEK (High Energy Accelerator Research Organization), Japan Jul 2014 “Laser break-down spectroscopy on alloys”	
WORKSHOPS	2026 Northeast Regional Disordered Proteins Workshop: Function Without Form, Syracuse, NY, Sep 17–18, 2026. <i>Speaker</i>. Simons Center for Geometry and Physics: Physics and mathematics of turbulence in different media, New York, NY, Aug 24–Oct 9, 2026. (<i>invited</i>) Gordon Research Seminar & Conference: Soft Condensed Matter Physics, New London, NH, Aug 10–15, 2025. <i>Discussion Leader</i> at Gordon Research Seminar. Schmidt Science Leadership Program, 2024 – 2025, Oxford, UK; Palo Alto, CA; Pasadena, CA; three weeks total. <i>Invited Speaker</i> at 2025 Interdisciplinary Science Summit. Finding Your Research Voice Workshop, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, May 8 – 9, 2025. Aspen Center for Physics Winter Conference: Computing with Physical Systems, Aspen, CO, Jan 7–12, 2024. Simons Foundation Workshop: Turbulence Across Vast Scales, New York, NY, Dec 2 – 9, 2019.	
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Teaching Assistant Experimental Physics (PHYS 211) Computational Physics (PHYS 250) Honors Waves, Optics, & Heat (PHYS 143) Waves, Optics, and Heat (PHYS 133) Electricity and Magnetism (PHYS 132) Mechanics (PHYS 131)	Department of Physics, University of Chicago, USA Winter 2019 Fall 2018 Spring 2018 Spring 2017 Winter 2017 Fall 2016
	Teaching Assistant Thermal Physics (PHYS 360) Quantum Mechanics (PHYS 420) Astrophysics (PHYS 480) Modern Physics (PHYS 220) Optics and Waves (PHYS 152) Electricity and Magnetism (PHYS 150)	Department of Physics, Kalamazoo College, USA Winter 2016 Fall 2016 Fall 2016 Fall 2014 Spring 2014 Winter 2014
	Student Instructor Tutored calculus, linear algebra, and the introductory physics sequence	Kalamazoo College, USA Apr 2014 – Mar 2016
STUDENTS MENTORED	Cornell University Karthik Varma, Graduate researcher 2023 - present Jen Jang, Graduate researcher, 2024 - present Sully Robert Bailey-Darland, Graduate researcher, 2024 - present Katia Larina, Graduate researcher, 2025 - present Allison Dew, Undergraduate researcher, 2025 - 2026 Blue Shapiro, Graduate researcher, 2024 - 2025 <i>After: Material Scientist at Vandstrom</i> Dana Matthias, Undergraduate researcher, 2024 - 2025 <i>After: Master’s program, ETH Zürich</i> University of Chicago Matteo Sabato, Graduate researcher, 2020 - 2023 Yaocheng Li, Graduate researcher, 2020 - 2023 Diego Padilla, Undergraduate researcher, 2021 <i>After: Ph.D. program, UCLA</i>	
SERVICE AND OUTREACH	Reviewer: <i>Nature Physics; Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences; Biophysical Journal; Matter; European Journal of Mechanics B: Fluids</i> Editorial writing: News & Views article for <i>Nature Physics</i> Jan 2026 Discussion leader: Gordon Research Conference: Soft Condensed Matter Physics Aug 2025 Session chair: 12th Liquid Matter Conference, Mainz, Germany Sep 2024 Instructor: - Special Education Aide (weekly) Sep 2021 – Jun 2024 <i>Provided individualized educational support for children with autism spectrum disorder and</i>	

trauma-related challenges.

- Mentor for Science and Technology Outreach Program (biweekly) Sep 2014 – Apr 2016
Designed and taught courses about coding, electronics, and robotics for middle school students.

Demonstrator/Volunteer:

- Physics With a Bang!, MRSEC at the University of Chicago (annual) 2019 – 2023
- SMART Science Outreach Program, MRSEC at the University of Chicago Jul 2020
- Beyond the Naked Eye, Marwen Art School and the University of Chicago Jun 2017
Exhibited science-inspired art and photography on pattern formation and fluid instabilities.

Speaker and Panelist:

- Career panel, Society of Physics Students, Kalamazoo College Chapter Apr 2026
- Research symposium, Consulate-General of Japan in Chicago Jun 2018

Mentor: Organization for underrepresented students in STEM, Kalamazoo College 2015 – 2016

REFERENCES

Professor William T. M. Irvine

Department of Physics, University of Chicago

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Professor Eric R. Dufresne

Department of Physics and Department of Materials Science and Engineering, Cornell University

erd43@cornell.edu

Professor Nigel Goldenfeld

Department of Physics, University of California, San Diego

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